Hardware: Hardware is the physical aspect of computers. Computer hardware is the collection of physical parts of a computer system. This includes the computer case, monitor, keyboard, and mouse. It also includes all the parts inside the computer case, such as the hard disk drive, motherboard, video card, and many others. These are called hardware since these components can be seen and touched by the user.

Software: The sets of computer program instructions that direct the operation of the hardware are called software. A complete set of instructions to execute a related set of tasks is a program.These are called software because the programmes cannot be seen or touched. Software instructions are termed as code. Software can be divided into two major categories:

1) **System Software :** System software means the operating system. It is the collection of programs that directs a computer to perform functions associated with controlling and directing computer hardware and also determines how application software is run.

2) **Application Software:** Application software refers to the computer programs written for an individual application such as payroll processing or personnel skill analysis.They generally require system software in their execution. For example, the application program may specify reading data from a record stored on a disk; the operating system provides the instructions to manage the physical reading of the record from disk storage.

6.7. Role of Computers in Office:

The following are the major role of computers in office

1) **Data Storage:** The data storage and retrieval capacity of computers are greater and more advanced as technology improves. Files are easily retrievable through search functions, and hard drives can hold extraordinary volumes of files and data. For offices with large databases this data storage and retrieval function provides unparalleled advantages over traditional paper file storage, such as the ease and speed of information retrieval, the ease of changing data records and the ease of tracking changes made to customer record.

2) **Communication:** Internal and external communication is much easier with the use of e-mail and internal messaging systems on computers. Office staffs are able to pass information throughout the office quickly and effectively, as most office setups have an alert system on individual computers when a message or e-mail is received.

3) **Networking:** File sharing is one of the key benefits of networking computers in an office environment. Office networking, or the creation of an office intranet means that a common database of files is accessible to all users. This also applies to software and management of computers, which significantly reduces costs for offices, as they can purchase one networkable software product instead of having to purchase multiple copies for individual computers. Networking also

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